

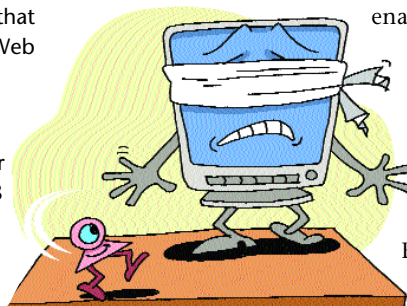
Web cam not detected

Q. I have a Celeron PC running Windows 98. Recently I bought a new Web cam. My problem is that when I connect the Web cam to a USB port, Windows does not detect it. I installed it on another computer with the Windows 98 setup, and it worked just fine. What could be the problem?

Prashanth
Via e-mail

A. It is possible that the onboard USB is not enabled in your motherboard. To enable onboard USB, you need to access BIOS setup (Press [Delete] when you get to the Power-on Self Test screen during bootup) and select the 'Integrated Peripherals' option. Here you will find the options to enable/disable onboard USB. Enable it and restart your machine with the device plugged in. Your PC should now be able to detect your Web cam.

ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar



does not appear. On booting the machine, it directly shows the Windows 98/Windows XP boot screen and to access Linux I have to insert the boot diskette for Linux. Why is this happening?

Sanjeev Chharia
Via e-mail

A. There are two possibilities as to why this is happening:
■ Linux gives users an option for selecting the location where the LILO needs to be loaded—you can opt for the MBR (Master Boot Record) or the first sector of the hard disk. In case it is loaded in the first sector of the hard disk, you will not get an option for selecting Linux as an operating system. To select Linux through a menu option, LILO must be loaded on the MBR.

■ While installing various operating systems on a single machine, all Microsoft operating systems need to be installed before you install Linux, as Microsoft boot loaders do not have any option of either writing to a specified location or appending the MBR. To get a selection of all the operating systems through LILO, you must always install Linux last. Hence, you might need to reinstall Linux.

Ctfmon.exe launches at startup

Q. Recently, I found a file

named ctfmon.exe in the startup tab in System Configuration Utility. I don't remember enabling this file to be launched at Startup. Now, when I press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Delete], this file gets listed. When I click on it and click 'End Task', a popup window appears saying that the application is not responding. Ctfmon.exe is found in my windows\system directory. Even after I disabled it in the Startup tab, it starts automatically when I restart my computer. What is it and why is it acting like this?

K. Mohan Doss
Via e-mail

A. Ctfmon.exe is a file that activates the Alternative User Input and the Microsoft Office Language Bar in Office

XP. It monitors the active windows and provides text input service support for speech recognition, handwriting recognition, keyboard, translation, and other alternative user input technologies. Removing or deleting this file might cause your Office XP programs to behave erratically. So instead of deleting it, the proper procedure is to run the Office XP Installer and access the **Maintenance Mode > Add/Remove features**. Here, choose the 'Installation' option for all Office applications and tools and select 'Office Shared Features' through which you can remove Alternative User Input (select 'Not Available'). This should fix it.

VB Runtime Error

Q. I have a Celeron 366 MHz machine with 128 MB RAM and I have Windows 98 installed. When I run certain programs I get an error that says, 'MSVBVM50.DLL missing. Illegal operation'. What does this mean?

K. Vashani
Via e-mail

A. Msvbvm50.dll is the Visual Basic Virtual Machine and is the required run-time

library for Visual Basic 5.0 applications. This error message pops up when either the file is corrupted or when it has been overwritten by an older version. The version of Msvbvm50.dll that is included in Windows 98 is 05.00.4319. You can download this file from <http://download.microsoft.com/download/vb50pro/utility/1/win98/EN-US/Msvbvm50.exe>

Error starting Yahoo! Messenger

Q. I have a PC with a Pentium 100 MHz processor, 16 MB RAM and 2 GB hard disk. Recently, I downloaded and installed Yahoo! Messenger, but when I started it, I got an error message saying 'Error Starting Program, The YPAGER.EXE file is linked to missing export COMCTL32.DLL:_Track Mouse Event'. What does this mean?

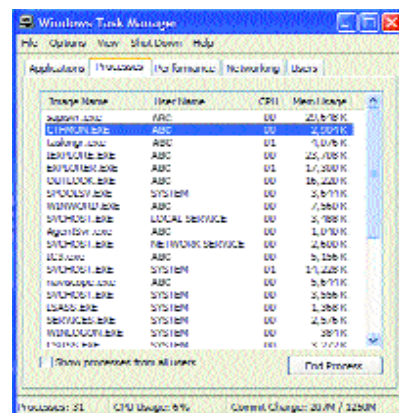
V. Sule
Via e-mail

A. This problem is caused by an old system file on your computer, which needs to be updated. The only way to do this is to install Internet Explorer 5 on your computer. If you use Netscape as your browser, even then you'll have to install Internet Explorer to get rid of this problem—you don't have to use Internet Explorer, just installing it is sufficient.

CDs don't play in MP3 player

Q. I face a problem while playing songs on my MP3 player. I convert CDA format into MP3 format using Gamut Player or Audiograbber software. I write them onto a CD using a 16x CD-Writer. This is where the problem starts—the CD plays on my PC, but refuses to play on my player. How do I fix this?

Sachin
Via e-mail



Ctfmon loads when speech recognition is selected